Zachari Pond

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Education

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D. in Agricultural & Resource Economics — Expected 2027
Committee: James Sallee (chair), Dmitry Taubinsky, Kelsey Jack, Meredith Fowlie
M.S. in Agricultural & Resource Economics — 2023

Brigham Young University
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics, *summa cum laude* — 2021

Fields

Environmental Economics, Behavioral Economics, Public Economics

References

James Sallee
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
University of California, Berkeley
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Dmitry Taubinsky
Department of Economics
University of California, Berkeley
dmitry.taubinsky@berkeley.edu

Kelsey Jack
Haas School of Business
University of California, Berkeley
kelseyjack@berkeley.edu

Job Market Paper

"The Welfare Effects of Providing Information about Externalities."

Abstract: This paper combines theory and experiments to study the welfare effects of providing information about personal carbon emissions. Governments and agencies routinely use information to motivate prosocial behavior. The welfare effects of doing so depend not only on how behavior changes, but also on how information affects the people who receive it: by improving their decisions, or by producing guilt, pride, or shame. I develop a model with altruism, social-image, and self-image utility that decomposes the total welfare effect of an information intervention into: the instrumental value of the information, its direct effect on image utility, and the external damages avoided through induced abatement. I then estimate these components in experiments with about 6,500 U.S. adults for three interventions: private information on the dollar damages from one's emissions, private information on one's emissions rank, and public recognition, which discloses one's emissions to another participant. I measure consumer welfare effects with an incentive-compatible strategy-method elicitation of willingness to pay to receive or avoid each intervention. I estimate abatement effects both structurally and as randomized treatment effects on contributions to emissions offsets. Private information raises consumer welfare but does not detectably change abatement. Public recognition increases abatement, but decreases consumer welfare and total welfare. Evaluating these interventions by behavior alone would reverse their ranking.

Publications

Frandsen, B. and Z. A. Pond. 2025. "Simultaneous Confidence Intervals for Partially Identified Parameters." *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*, 43(1): 232–240.

Working Papers

"The Welfare Effects of Climate Change for Outdoor Recreation," with J. Gellman and M. Wibbenmeyer.

Pre-PhD Publications (Environmental Health)

Pond, Z. A., P. K. Saha, C. J. Coleman, A. A. Presto, A. L. Robinson, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Mortality Risk and Long-term Exposure to Ultrafine Particles and Primary Fine Particle Components in a National US Cohort." *Environment International*, 167: 107439.

Coleman, C. J., R. A. Yeager, Z. A. Pond, D. W. Riggs, A. Bhatnagar, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Mortality Risk Associated with Greenness, Air Pollution, and Physical Activity in a Representative US Cohort." *Science of the Total Environment*, 824: 153848.

Pond, Z. A., C. S. Hernandez, P. J. Adams, S. N. Pandis, G. R. Garcia, A. L. Robinson, J. D. Marshall, R. Burnett, K. Skyllakou, P. Garcia Rivera, E. Karnezi, C. J. Coleman, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Cardiopulmonary Mortality and Fine Particulate Air Pollution by Species and Source in a National US Cohort." *Environmental Science & Technology*, 56(11): 7214–7223.

Garcia III, G. R., N. C. Coleman, Z. A. Pond, and C. A. Pope III. 2021. "Shape of BMI-Mortality Risk Associations: Reverse Causality and Heterogeneity in a Representative Cohort of US Adults." *Obesity*, 29(4): 755–766.

Pope III, C. A., N. Coleman, Z. A. Pond, and R. T. Burnett. 2020. "Fine Particulate Air Pollution and Human Mortality: 25+ Years of Cohort Studies." *Environmental Research*, 183: 108924.

Research & Professional Experience

Research Intern, Resources for the Future	2023
Research Assistant to C. Arden Pope III, Brigham Young University	2019–2021
Research Assistant to Brigham Frandsen, Brigham Young University	2020–2021

Grants & Awards

Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2026
Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2024
Xlab Graduate Student Research Funding ($7,000)	2024
Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2023
Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award, UC Berkeley	2022

Teaching Experience

Economic Analysis for Business Decisions, UC Berkeley Haas (MBA)	2026
Intermediate Microeconomics with Applications to Sustainability, UC Berkeley	2025, 2026
Natural Resource Economics, UC Berkeley	2025
Environmental Economics, UC Berkeley	2022, 2024
Psychology and Economics, UC Berkeley	2023
Economics of Water Resources, UC Berkeley	2023
International Environmental Economics, UC Berkeley	2021, 2022
Introduction to Econometrics, Brigham Young University	2020
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Brigham Young University	2019

Conferences & Presentations

USDA W5133 Environmental Economics Annual Meeting	2026
AERE Summer Conference	2024
AERE Sessions at the Western Economic Association International Annual Conference	2024

Service

Admissions Committee, UC Berkeley ARE	2025
Graduate Assembly Delegate, UC Berkeley	2023

Referee

Journal of Public Economics

Last updated: October 15, 2026